YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Pandan Chiffon

P G T N

Light structure that rises with your child.

YOUR CODE

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



P

HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Planner

G

WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Gardener

T

WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Talker

N

COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Nester

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The No Beside the Candy Shelf

At the supermarket checkout, your child asks for candy. You say no gently. They ask again, louder. A minute later they are crying on the floor while people glance over their baskets. Your chest tightens. If I were truly gentle, you think, my child would not be this upset.

As a Pandan Chiffon parent, you notice every shift in a child's face. You make room for feelings so naturally that disappointment can start to feel like evidence that you caused harm. But softness without an edge eventually asks you to disappear.



You kneel down, not to change the answer but to steady yourself. “You really wanted it. You can be sad, and the answer is still no.” Then you stop explaining. Your body gets to keep one boundary too.

The crying does not end immediately. That is not proof the boundary failed. Outside, your child takes your hand and asks about the rain. Nothing in the relationship has broken. You were warm and firm in the same moment, the kind of soft structure that can rise without collapsing.



WHAT TO REMEMBER

WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You are highly attuned to your child's signals and want home to stay gentle. Saying no or seeing disappointment can immediately feel as if you have hurt them.

RELEASE THE GUILT

A warm boundary is not rejection. Your child may be disappointed and still loved; you may be firm and still be a gentle parent.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. You read your kid's cues like a pro
2. Soft landings for every big feeling
3. Unhurried presence, no rush, just here

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

Gentle can drift into no-limits. Kids need edges too, soft ones still count. 🌿

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Gentle parenting

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Say one no without a long explanation
- [ ] Take a quiet pause
- [ ] Say: “You may feel sad, and the answer is still not yet.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Start one day this week with no list at all.
- [ ] Once this week, decide without offering a choice.
- [ ] Just once, listen all the way to the end without offering a solution.
- [ ] Hold back one "be careful" today.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Anticipating. Your head keeps running even when your body sits down.

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Vigilance. Everyone's sense of safety is parked with you.

FOR YOU FIRST

Honor one limit in your body or energy before it is depleted. Healthy gentleness includes you.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

TIME 15 MIN

An empty block on the calendar

If every hour has a name, there is nowhere for recovery to happen. This block succeeds by staying empty.

Put one block in the calendar with nothing in it. Defend it the way you'd defend a meeting with someone else.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

TIME 15 MIN

Tend something that isn't your child

You're good at tending things that grow slowly. Fifteen minutes of care that reports to nobody and thanks you by growing.

Water the plants, prune something, feed the sourdough. Anything that grows and isn't your child.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

TIME 2 MIN

Six long exhales

Two minutes, no equipment, can be done standing in the kitchen. For a parent who absorbs feelings all day, this is the cheapest reset there is.

Six breaths where the out-breath is longer than the in-breath. Slower than feels natural.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

TIME 5 MIN

Five warm minutes

You are the one who makes everyone else feel safe. This time the comfort points at you, and that's allowed.

Warm shower, warm blanket, warm mug — five minutes of heat on your skin with nothing else happening.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child needs empathy and a clear edge so they do not have to guess who is holding the situation.

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

0–12 MONTHS · 5 MIN

Peekaboo, with a scarf

The oldest turn-taking game there is, played at your baby's pace instead of yours.

1. Drape a light scarf over your own face, not theirs.
2. Wait for their sound or reach before you reveal.
3. Stop the moment they look away — that's them saying done.

You'll need: One light, breathable scarf.

Safety first: The scarf goes over you, never the baby. Never leave fabric on or near a baby's face.

Grounded in: Serve and return (Harvard)

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Move the water with a sponge

The water does the correcting, not you. The spill is part of the activity, not a failure of it.

1. Set two shallow bowls on a towel, one with a little water.
2. Show the squeeze once.
3. Put a small cloth beside them and let them mop it themselves.

You'll need: Two shallow bowls, one small sponge, a towel, a cloth.

Safety first: A very small amount of water, always within arm's reach. A toddler can drown in a few centimetres.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

2–3 YEARS · 15 MIN

Build the calm basket together

Assembling the box while nobody is upset works far better than looking for it mid-meltdown.

1. Offer a basket and ask what helps when their feelings get big.
2. Put in whatever they say, even if it seems useless to you.
3. Name the feelings that come up as you talk, without fixing them.

You'll need: A basket, plus their choices: a soft toy, a picture, a squeeze ball, a blanket.

Safety first: Nothing that can be tied, wrapped, or pulled over the head.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

Draw anything, I'll just be here

"What is it?" makes a child guess the answer you want. Describing what you see asks nothing of them.

1. Paper and crayons, both of you at the table.
2. Describe colours, movements, choices — "you used a lot of blue there".
3. Never ask "what is it?", and never correct a colour or a shape.

You'll need: Paper and crayons.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

One real step in the cooking

Not pretend cooking. One genuine step of the meal the family actually eats, done by them.

1. Choose one safe step: tearing lettuce, peeling a banana, spreading butter, stirring off the heat.
2. Give them the real tool, child-sized if you have one.
3. At the table, say out loud which part they made.

You'll need: Whatever you're already cooking.

Safety first: Nothing at the stove, nothing sharp, nothing hot. Hands washed, and an adult stays in the kitchen.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life

ILLUSTRATION TO COME

No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



Scan to send the quiz to someone else

EXPLORE PARENTEERS ACTIVITIES

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Made with ❤️ (and cold coffee) by Parenteers

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